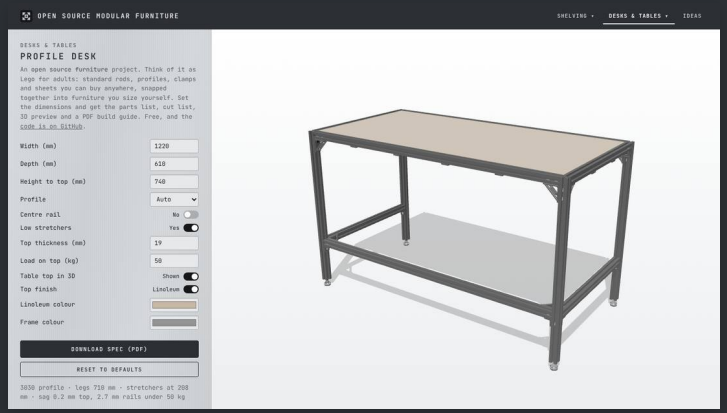
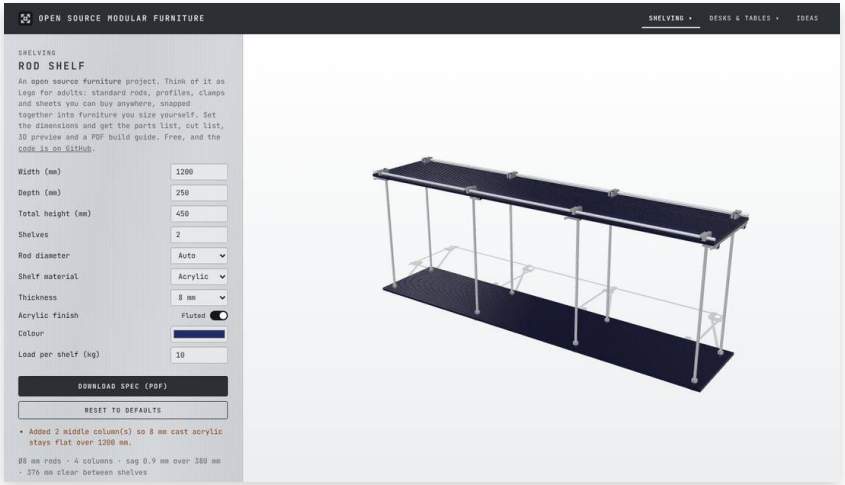
Design furniture with us

How to contribute to Open Source Modular Furniture with the Claude desktop app. No coding needed: you design, Claude builds.

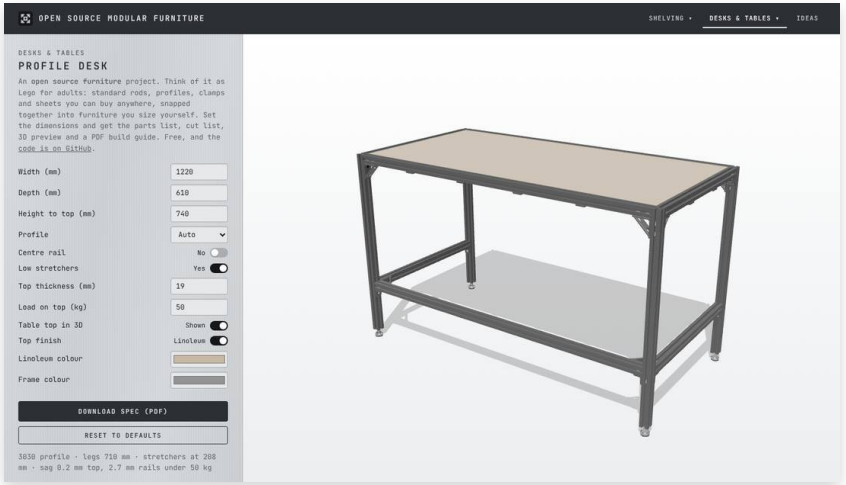


Lego for adults, sized by anyone

Standard parts you can buy anywhere, snapped together into furniture people size themselves. Each piece is a page on the site, picked from the top menu: a configurator.

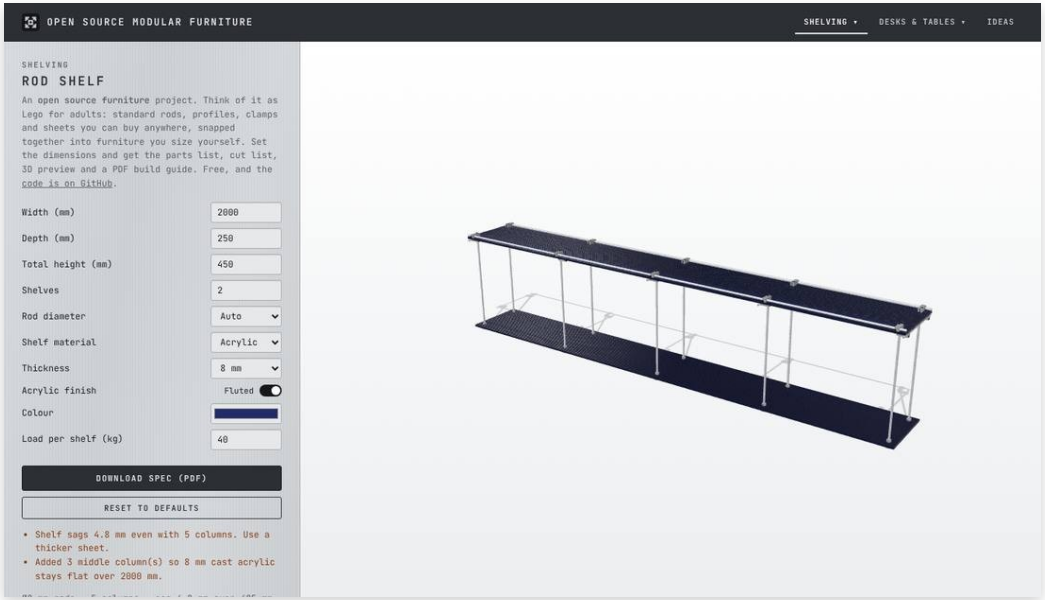


Rod shelf: chrome rods, cross clamps, acrylic or wood sheets



Profile desk: T-slot aluminium, brackets, plywood top

What a configurator gives people



1. **Settings**
   Width, depth, height and options, with sensible limits

2. **Rules and warnings**
   At 2000 mm the shelf adds middle columns and warns it still sags

3. **3D preview**
   Click any part to see what it is and where to buy it

4. **Parts list and PDF**
   Exact quantities, cut lengths and an IKEA-style build guide

You design, Claude builds

You, the designer

- What the piece is and how it looks
- Which real parts to buy, and their sizes
- How it goes together, step by step
- What people can change, and the limits
- Saying "yes, that looks right" or "move this"

Claude, in the desktop app

- Sets up and runs the site on your computer
- Writes the code and the tests
- Shows you a screenshot after every change
- Saves versions as it goes
- Writes and opens the pull request

From idea to pull request



Set up
Once: account and app

Run the site
On your own computer

Design brief
An interview, written down

Build in rounds
Check each one

Try it in Chrome
Your own local copy

Send
The pull request

Everything starts with one sentence. Open the project in the Claude desktop app and say "let's work on this". Claude asks what you want to do and guides every step, telling you where you are ("Step 3 of 6").

One-time setup, about 15 minutes

1

GitHub account

Free, at github.com/signup

2

Claude desktop app

Download it from claude.ai/download and sign in

3

Open the project

In the app, open Code and choose the project. Claude can make your own copy (fork) on GitHub

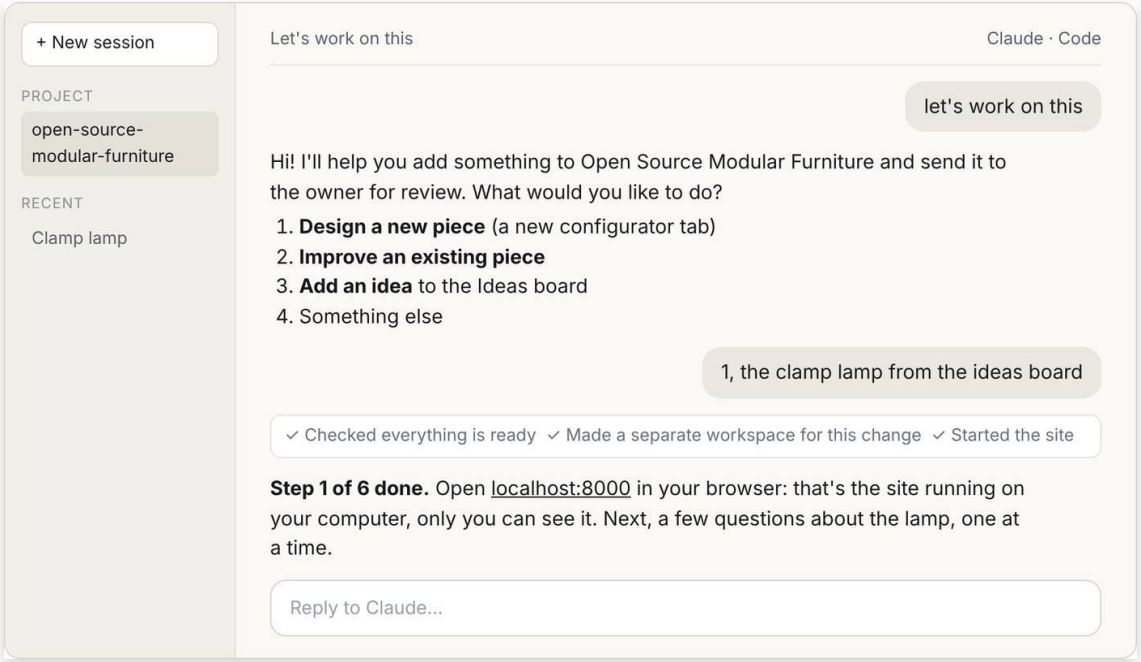
4

Ask

Type "let's work on this" and follow along

Say "let's work on this"

SIMULATED EXAMPLE

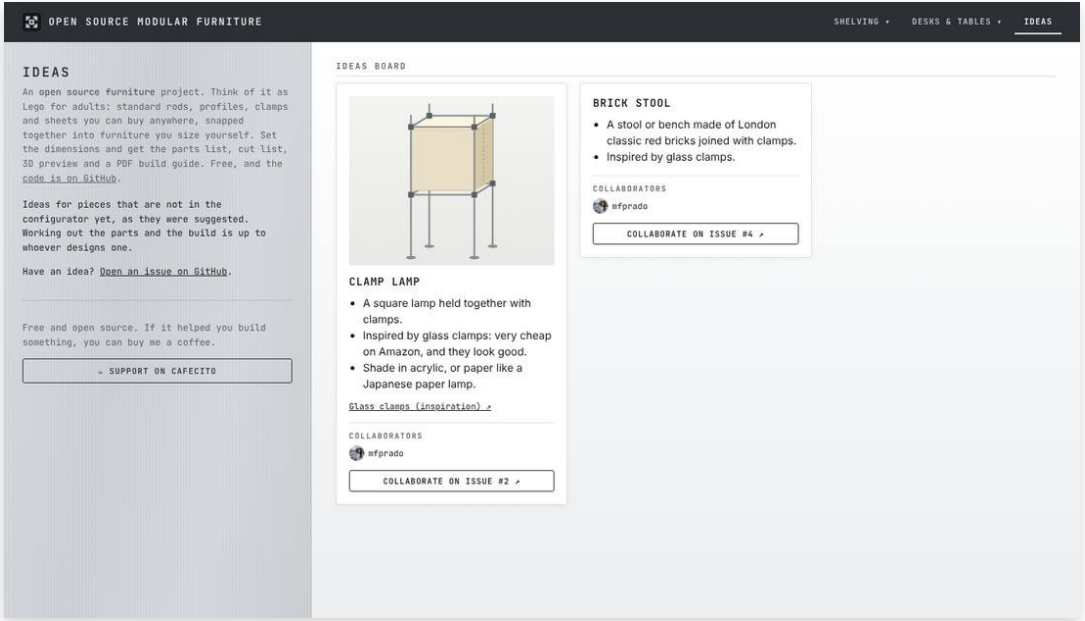


It offers four paths
Design a new piece, improve one, add an idea, or something else.

It checks your setup
Fixes what it can; asks you only for clicks it can't do, like signing in to GitHub.

It runs the site
At localhost:8000, only visible to you, updating on refresh.

Start from an idea on the board



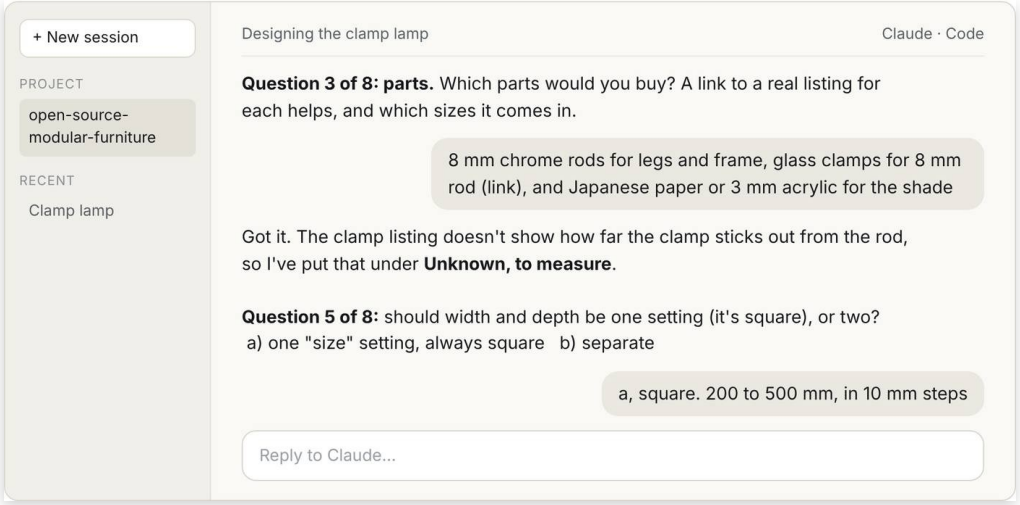
The Ideas page (top bar, right) lists pieces nobody has designed yet, as proposed, each with an open GitHub issue.

Pick one, or bring your own.

Claude reads the issue and its pictures, and offers to comment "I'm designing this" so nobody duplicates the work.

One question at a time

SIMULATED EXAMPLE



Unknown means unknown. Any size not on a listing goes on a "to measure" list instead of a guess.

1. What is it?
2. Pictures
3. Parts, with real listings
4. How it goes together
5. What people can change
6. Rules
7. What can go wrong
8. How it looks in 3D

The brief is the plan

SIMULATED EXAMPLE

docs/designs/clamp-lamp.md

Clamp lamp

A square lamp held together with clamps; shade in paper or acrylic. Idea: #2.

Parts

Part	Sizes available	Key dimensions	Source
Chrome rod	Ø8 mm	cut to length	listing link, read 2026-10-27
Glass clamp	for Ø8 rod	reach: unknown	listing link
Shade panel	paper, 3 mm acrylic	size × height	designer

Settings on the site

Setting	Default	Min	Max	Step / choices
Size (mm)	300	200	500	10
Shade	Paper	Paper / Acrylic		

Rules (example values)

• Legs are 1.3 × the shade height. • A second frame ring when the shade is taller than 400 mm.

Warnings

• Acrylic shade over 400 mm: check the bulb's heat rating.

Unknown, to measure

• How far the glass clamp reaches from the rod.

Saved in the project
`docs/designs/<piece>.md`

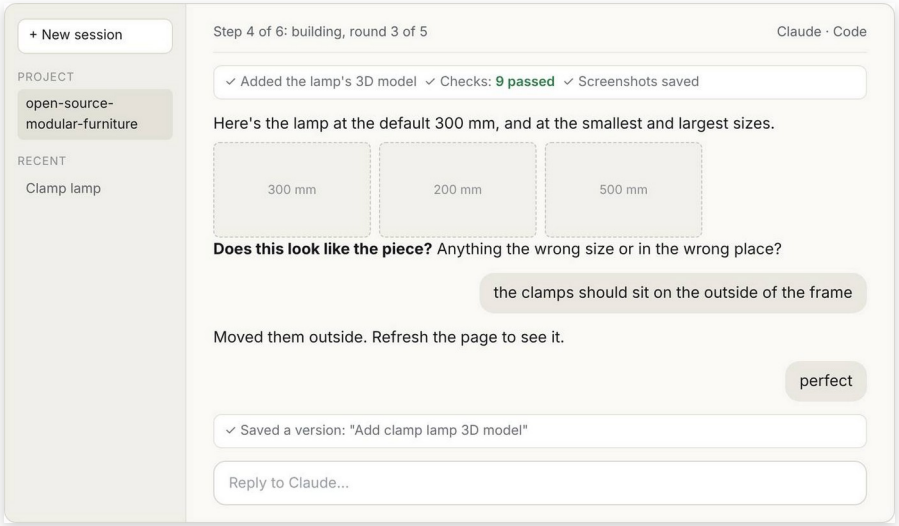
You approve it first
Nothing is built until you say it's right.

The owner reviews it first
Parts, settings, rules, warnings, assembly and unknowns, all in one page.

Build in rounds, check each one

Parts list | Tab and settings | **3D model** | Part info | PDF guide

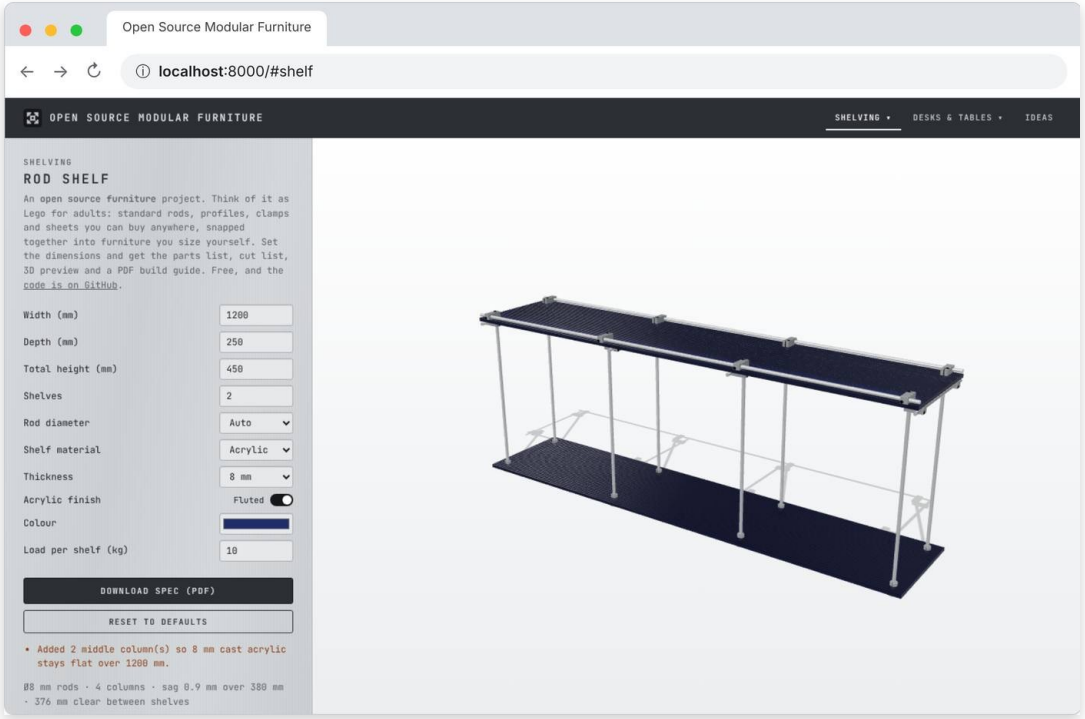
SIMULATED EXAMPLE



Every round
builds, tests, shows you a screenshot, asks "does this look right?", then saves a version.

The 3D model usually takes a few tries. That's expected.

Step 5: your own copy of the site



The real site
`mfprado.github.io/…`
The shop window. Everyone sees it. It only changes after the owner approves.

Your local copy
`localhost:8000`
The prototype on your workbench. Only on your computer, only you see it, and it shows your changes straight away.

Open it in Chrome, in three moves

1

Ask Claude to start it

Claude does this for you at the start. Keep the chat open: closing it switches the copy off.

2

Type localhost:8000

Open Chrome, click the address bar at the top, type localhost:8000 and press Enter.

3

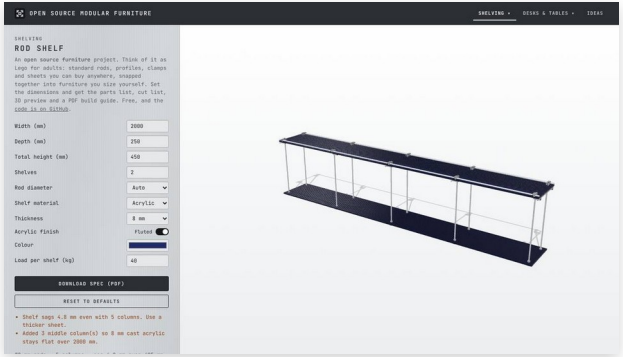
Refresh after each change

Press Cmd+R on a Mac or Ctrl+R on Windows to see what Claude just changed.

"This site can't be reached"? The copy is switched off. Nothing is broken: just ask Claude to start the site again.

Try it like a visitor would

- ✔ Smallest and largest sizes
- ✔ Each option on and off
- ✔ Make each warning appear
- ✔ Click parts in the 3D view
- ✔ Find it in the top menu
- ✔ Download and read the PDF
- ✔ Shelf and desk still work
- ✔ Narrow window, like a phone

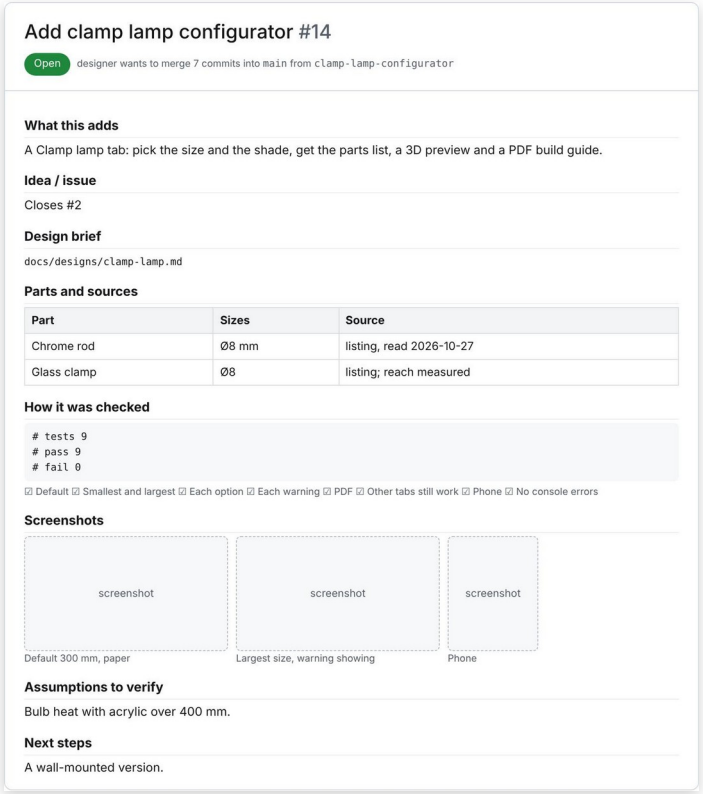


Real example: making a warning appear (2000 mm wide, 40 kg)

Found something odd? Tell Claude in plain words ("the warning is confusing"). It fixes it, you refresh, you check again.
Then Claude runs its own checks and takes the screenshots for the pull request.

A standard pull request

SIMULATED EXAMPLE



Add clamp lamp configurator #14

Open designer wants to merge 7 commits into main from clamp-lamp-configurator

What this adds

A Clamp lamp tab: pick the size and the shade, get the parts list, a 3D preview and a PDF build guide.

Idea / issue

Closes #2

Design brief

docs/designs/clamp-lamp.md

Parts and sources

Part	Sizes	Source
Chrome rod	Ø8 mm	listing, read 2026-10-27
Glass clamp	Ø8	listing; reach measured

How it was checked

```
# tests 9
# pass 9
# fail 0
```

☑ Default ☑ Smallest and largest ☑ Each option ☑ Each warning ☑ PDF ☑ Other tabs still work ☑ Phone ☑ No console errors

Screenshots

screenshot — Default 300 mm, paper

screenshot — Largest size, warning showing

screenshot — Phone

Assumptions to verify

Bulb heat with acrylic over 400 mm.

Next steps

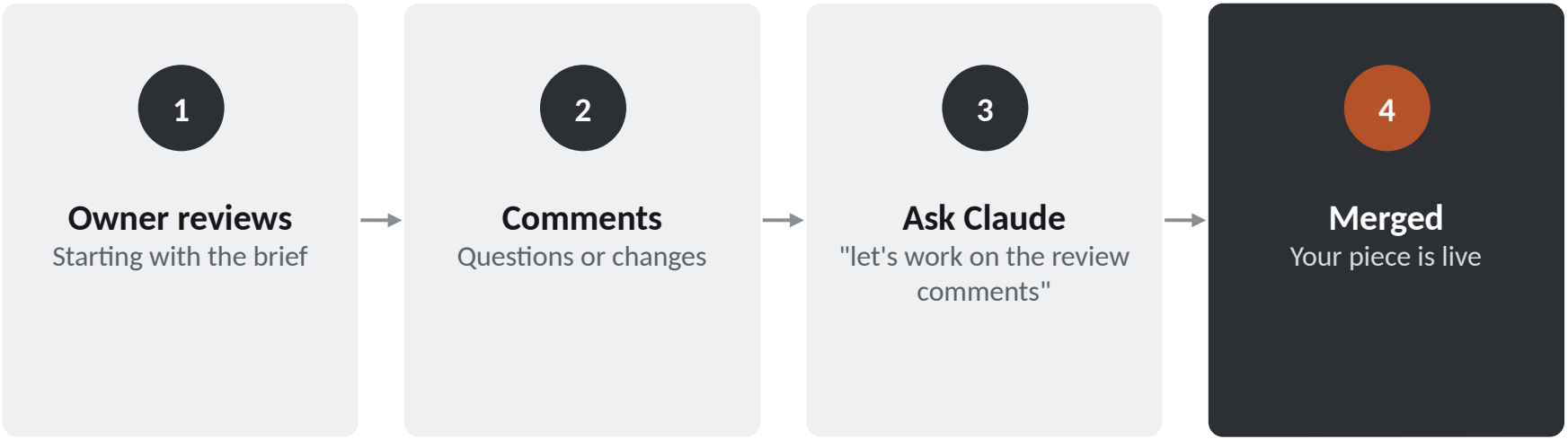
A wall-mounted version.

Every section is required, so review is quick:

1. What this adds
2. Idea / issue
3. Design brief
4. Parts and sources
5. How it was checked
6. Screenshots
7. Assumptions to verify
8. Next steps

Claude writes it. You drag the screenshots into it on GitHub.

After you send it



Changes go on the same pull request: Claude reads each comment, makes the change, and replies under it.

Three things to say

Repo: github.com/mfprado/open-source-modular-furniture

```
"let's work on this"
```

```
"turn the clamp lamp idea into a configurator"
```

```
"let's work on the review comments"
```